



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

COMMERCIAL & B2B RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering unpaid civil engineering and survey invoices — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Urban Strategy** · September 2026

The invoices that stall when the project does

To Anita Torres and the team at Urban Strategy — you told us you have roughly \$500,000 outstanding. In land development that number rarely means anyone refuses to pay. It means the grading and drainage design is finished, the ALTA survey is delivered, the plans are stamped — and the project sponsor is waiting on financing, on entitlements, or on their own capital partner.

Engineering receivables age for a structural reason. Your work is front-loaded: the design and the survey land early, the developer's money arrives late. Many projects are held in single-purpose entities that go quiet when the deal stalls, and the project manager who authorized your scope moves to another firm. The invoice does not get disputed. It just stops moving.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced commercial receivables recovery partner working business-to-business balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, from 12 offices across 7 states with recovery reach in all 50. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes your accounting or AR-aging export. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A track record built on business-to-business receivables and a documented, compliant process — matched to a firm licensed across Texas, Oklahoma, Louisiana, Arizona and Colorado.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

What a \$500,000 book actually needs

Written for a civil engineering and surveying firm billing developers, contractors, architects and public agencies across five states.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum, no cost to place. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. The rate scales with the age, balance and volume of what you place, and we quote it once we have seen a representative sample of your aging. On a book this size, that sample conversation is worth having before you place anything.
2. Single-purpose entities and stalled projects	The defining problem in land development AR. A project LLC goes dark and the balance looks uncollectible — but the principals, the parent developer and the successor entity usually are not hard to find. We run commercial skip tracing on the entity, its registered agent, its officers and its affiliates, then work the party that actually has the money rather than the shell that signed the contract.
3. Scope and change-order disputes	The common stall in engineering is not refusal, it is “that was not in the original scope.” A dispute pauses recovery, it does not end it. We validate against the paper — the executed proposal, the change orders, submitted deliverables, the plan-review and revision trail. In your work the deliverable itself is usually decisive: the stamped plans were issued and the survey was recorded.
4. Public agencies and prime contractors	Work billed to municipalities and to primes behaves differently from work billed to a developer. Agency payables move slowly but reliably and usually need process pressure, not legal pressure. Balances behind a prime contractor need the chain documented. We handle these separately rather than running one script across the whole book.
5. Multi-state and legal escalation	Recovery reach is nationwide, which matches your licensure across Texas, Oklahoma, Louisiana, Arizona and Colorado. Legal escalation is reviewed case by case and never without your sign-off. On construction and development balances there are often statutory remedies with hard deadlines attached — if you have not had counsel review those on the older invoices in this book, that is worth doing in parallel with placement, not after.

Accounting-system-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built to take your AR exports and give your accounting team live, self-service visibility without an email chain.

ACCOUNTING-SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an AR-aging export from QuickBooks, Deltek, Ajera or a spreadsheet — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send executed proposals, change orders, stamped deliverables and survey records safely inside the portal — the documentation that settles a scope dispute.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export recovery reports on demand, across the whole book or by client, project or office.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a client makes straight to Urban Strategy, so balances stay accurate and no one is contacted twice.

► Portal Video Tour

SWRS Commercial Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's commercial book, anonymized by sector and shown at a range of scales including one comparable to a \$500,000 book. The spread is real and it includes a poor result — recovery tracks the age and documentation of the file, not the promise in a pitch.

CIVIL & SITE ENGINEERING

FIRM

Multi-discipline
engineering

\$20K recovered

of ~\$25K placed

80% recovered

COMMERCIAL SERVICES

CONTRACTOR

Large-scale exposition
services

\$287K recovered

of ~\$518K placed

55% recovered

SPECIALTY CONSULTING

PRACTICE

Fire-protection consulting

\$47K recovered

of ~\$92K placed

51% recovered

MECHANICAL & ENGINEERING

SERVICES

Systems engineering

\$29K recovered

of ~\$70K placed

41% recovered

DESIGN-BUILD CONTRACTOR

Design & construction

\$30K recovered

of ~\$76K placed

40% recovered

CIVIL ENGINEERING FIRM

Site & infrastructure
engineering

\$28K recovered

of ~\$119K placed

24% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

**THE AGE
CURVE**

On a book this size, the placement date is worth more than the collector

A commercial balance is most collectible while the project is still live and the people who authorized the work are still in their jobs. Every quarter it ages, the project entity reorganizes, the developer's PM moves firms, contact data goes stale and leverage erodes. The highest-return change most firms make is not chasing harder — it is placing sooner.

FRESH ACCOUNTS

Balances under roughly 90 days past due often resolve inside 30–60 days; an invoice that has sat two years collects a fraction of that — the low end of the range on the left.

A STANDING RULE BEATS A JUDGMENT CALL

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy recovers materially more than deciding account by account, and on pure contingency there is no cost to placing one that later pays you directly.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio. SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any account is worked.

Cutting the days between stamped and paid

Days Sales Outstanding measures one thing: how long completed work sits as a receivable before it becomes cash. Median B2B DSO runs about 43.5 days and the strongest quartile collects in roughly 25. For a 32-person firm carrying payroll, licensure and survey crews against work already delivered, every month past that is working capital financed out of the firm's own pocket.



Stalled projects and silent entities

Commercial skip tracing on the project LLC, its principals, its parent and its successors — so you are working the party with the money, not the shell.



Scope and change-order disputes

Documentation-driven validation using executed proposals, change orders, stamped deliverables and the revision trail.



Developers, primes and public agencies

Three payer types that behave differently, worked as three approaches rather than one script.



Multi-state reach

Recovery across all 50 states from 12 offices in 7 states — matched to licensure in TX, OK, LA, AZ and CO.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Urban Strategy

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

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Disputed & Non-Responsive B2B Invoices

Refusal vs. dispute · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn your aging receivables back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk your \$500,000 book by age, payer type and balance size, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Urban Strategy. FDCA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.